



CITY OF CAMBRIDGE

CITY COUNCIL FINAL ACTIONS • MARCH 09, 2026

Regular Meeting

Sullivan Chamber

5:30 PM

Cambridge City Hall, 795 Massachusetts Ave, Cambridge, MA 02139

Published March 10, 2026

ROLL CALL

Present: Councillor Ayah A. Al-Zubi
Vice Mayor Burhan Azeem
Councillor Timothy R. Flaherty
Councillor Marc McGovern
Councillor Patricia Nolan
Councillor E. Denise Simmons
Councillor Jivan Sobrinho-Wheeler
Councillor Catherine Zusy
Mayor Sumbul Siddiqui

Absent: None

I. PLEDGE OF ALLEGIANCE

II. SUBMISSION OF THE RECORD

1. Minutes of the Regular City Council meeting held on November 24, 2025

RESULT: Report Accepted and Placed on File VV9

2. The City Council held a Special Meeting on December 17, 2025 to review the City Manager's evaluation.

RESULT: Report Accepted and Placed on File VV9

III. CITY MANAGER'S AGENDA

1. A COMMUNICATION TRANSMITTED FROM YI-AN HUANG, CITY MANAGER, RELATIVE TO THE 2025 ANNUAL SURVEILLANCE REPORT CONCERNING CITY DEPARTMENTS' USE OF SURVEILLANCE TECHNOLOGY OR SURVEILLANCE DATA.
CMA 2026-44

RESULT: Referred to the Public Safety Committee VV9

2. A communication transmitted from Yi-An Huang, City Manager, relative to the City of Cambridge retaining its Triple A (AAA) rating from the nation's three major credit rating agencies.
CMA 2026-50

RESULT: CMA Placed on File VV8

ABSENT: Councillor Simmons

3. Transmitting a Communication from City Manager Yi-An Huang relative to the 2025/2026 Green Jobs Initiative Report.
CMA 2026-46

RESULT: CMA Placed on File VV9

4. Transmitting a Communication from Yi-An Huang, City Manager, relative to the appropriation of the Mass Save Community First Partnership Grant in the amount of \$256,500, to the Grant Fund Office of Sustainability Other Ordinary Maintenance Account. These funds will be used to contract for outreach services to support energy efficiency programs for residents and small businesses.
CMA 2026-47

RESULT: Adopted and CMA Placed on File [9-0-0]

YEAS: Councillor Al-Zubi, Vice Mayor Azeem, Councillor Flaherty, Councillor McGovern, Councillor Nolan, Councillor Simmons, Councillor Sobrinho-Wheeler, Councillor Zusy, Mayor Siddiqui

NAYS: None

PRESENT: None

ABSENT: None

5. A communication transmitted from Yi-An Huang, City Manager, relative to 2026-2027 Housing and Zoning priorities.
CMA 2026-49

RESULT: CMA Placed on File VV8

ABSENT: Councillor Al-Zubi

6. Transmitting a communication from City Manager, Yi-An Huang, regarding a free cash appropriation in the amount of \$400,000 to the General Fund Law Dept Travel and Training (Judgement and Damages) account for the settlement payment relating to Ahern v. Sig Sauer, Inc. and City of Cambridge (United States District Court District of Massachusetts, Docket No. 1:21-cv-11007-DJC).
- CMA 2026-51**

RESULT: Adopted [6-2-1]

YEAS: Vice Mayor Azeem, Councillor Flaherty, Councillor McGovern, Councillor Nolan, Councillor Simmons, Councillor Zusy

NAYS: Councillor Sobrinho-Wheeler, Mayor Siddiqui

PRESENT: None

ABSENT: Councillor Al-Zubi

IV. POLICY ORDERS

1. City Council opposition to the Department of Education's Proposed Reclassification of Professional Degrees.
COUNCILLOR MCGOVERN
MAYOR SIDDIQUI
POR 2026-52

RESULT: Adopted VV8
ABSENT: Councillor Al-Zubi

2. Recognize March 2026 as National Social Worker Month in the City of Cambridge.
COUNCILLOR MCGOVERN
MAYOR SIDDIQUI
POR 2026-53

RESULT: Adopted VV8
ABSENT: Councillor Al-Zubi

V. CALENDAR

CHARTER RIGHT

1. INCLUDE DISCUSSION OF OTHER CHANGES TO THE CAMBRIDGE STREET ZONING AT THE UPCOMING ORDINANCE COMMITTEE MEETING ABOUT ACTIVE GROUND FLOOR USE.

RESULT: Withdrawn [8-0-1]

YEAS: Vice Mayor Azeem, Councillor Flaherty, Councillor McGovern, Councillor Nolan, Councillor Simmons, Councillor Sobrinho-Wheeler, Councillor Zusy, Mayor Siddiqui

NAYS: None

PRESENT: None

ABSENT: Councillor Al-Zubi

TABLED

2. That the City Manager is requested to work with relevant City departments to raise the fee of the parking permit program for all residents to \$75, consider how to include a self-identified check off option so as not to increase administrative costs for a subsidized fee of \$25 for residents who live in affordable housing, are enrolled in a program such as SNAP or are low income, remove the senior exemption for the residential parking permit program and lower the number of cars that individual residents are allowed to get a residential parking permit for from four to two.

CHARTER RIGHT EXERCISED BY COUNCILLOR SIMMONS

IN COUNCIL FEBRUARY 9, 2026

PLACED ON THE TABLE IN COUNCIL MARCH 2, 2026

NO ACTION TAKEN IN COUNCIL MARCH 16, 2026

POR 2026-32

3. A communication transmitted from Yi-An Huang, City Manager, relative to a plan to align all housing and homeless services and programs into a unified Housing Department.

CMA 2026-24

BROUGHT FORWARD TO BE ADDRESSED IN SPECIAL PUBLIC HEARING AT 6:30PM
CLICK [HERE FOR THE CITY COUNCIL PUBLIC HEARING FINAL ACTIONS](#) WITH
VOTE RESULTS

UNFINISHED BUSINESS

4. AMEND SECTION 4.50 OF THE CAMBRIDGE ZONING ORDINANCE AS FOLLOWS WITH THE INTENT OF PERMITTING THE USE OF LAND FOR THE FOLLOWING PURPOSES AS-OF-RIGHT IN ALL ZONING DISTRICTS: RELIGIOUS PURPOSES; EDUCATIONAL PURPOSES ON LAND OWNED OR LEASED BY THE COMMONWEALTH OR ANY OF ITS AGENCIES, SUBDIVISIONS OR BODIES POLITIC OR BY A RELIGIOUS SECT OR DENOMINATION, OR BY A NONPROFIT EDUCATIONAL CORPORATION; AND FOR A CHILD CARE CENTER, SCHOOL-AGED CHILD CARE PROGRAM, FAMILY CHILD CARE HOME, OR LARGE FAMILY CHILD CARE HOME AS DEFINED IN SECTION 1A OF CHAPTER 15D OF MASSACHUSETTS GENERAL LAWS.

PASS TO A SECOND READING IN COUNCIL MARCH 2, 2026

NO ACTION TAKEN IN COUNCIL MARCH 16, 2026

ORD 2026-01

VI. COMMUNICATIONS

1. Communications for the March 9, 2026, City Council meeting
COM 2026-11

RESULT: Placed on File VV8

ABSENT: Councillor Al-Zubi

VII. RESOLUTIONS

1. Condolences To The Family of Alfredo Roderick Brown
COUNCILLOR SIMMONS
COUNCILLOR AL-ZUBI
VICE MAYOR AZEEM
COUNCILLOR FLAHERTY
COUNCILLOR MCGOVERN
COUNCILLOR NOLAN
COUNCILLOR SOBRINHO-WHEELER
COUNCILLOR ZUSY
MAYOR SIDDIQUI

RES 2026-34

RESULT: Adopted VV8

ABSENT: Councillor Al-Zubi

2. Condolences to the Family of Sylvia Kantor
COUNCILLOR SIMMONS
COUNCILLOR AL-ZUBI
VICE MAYOR AZEEM
COUNCILLOR FLAHERTY
COUNCILLOR MCGOVERN
COUNCILLOR NOLAN
COUNCILLOR SOBRINHO-WHEELER
COUNCILLOR ZUSY
MAYOR SIDDIQUI

RES 2026-35

RESULT: Adopted VV8

ABSENT: Councillor Al-Zubi

3. Condolences to the Family of Joseph Sater
COUNCILLOR SIMMONS
COUNCILLOR AL-ZUBI
VICE MAYOR AZEEM
COUNCILLOR FLAHERTY
COUNCILLOR MCGOVERN
COUNCILLOR NOLAN
COUNCILLOR SOBRINHO-WHEELER
COUNCILLOR ZUSY
MAYOR SIDDIQUI

RES 2026-36

RESULT: Adopted VV8

ABSENT: Councillor Al-Zubi

4. Condolences To The Family of Raymond T. Coleman
COUNCILLOR SIMMONS
COUNCILLOR AL-ZUBI
VICE MAYOR AZEEM
COUNCILLOR FLAHERTY
COUNCILLOR MCGOVERN
COUNCILLOR NOLAN
COUNCILLOR SOBRINHO-WHEELER
COUNCILLOR ZUSY
MAYOR SIDDIQUI

RES 2026-39

RESULT: Adopted VV8

ABSENT: Councillor Al-Zubi

VII. COMMITTEE REPORTS

1. The Housing Committee held a public hearing on December 16, 2025 to begin a discussion around social housing as referenced in POR 2025 #131.

CC 2026-22

RESULT: Report Accepted and Placed on File VV8

ABSENT: Councillor Al-Zubi

2. The Government Operations, Rules, and Claims Committee held a public hearing on January 29, 2026 to discuss City Council Rules for the 2026-2027 term.

CC 2026-21

RESULT: Report Accepted and Placed on File VV8

ABSENT: Councillor Al-Zubi

IX. COMMUNICATIONS FROM OTHER CITY OFFICERS

1. Communicating information from the School Committee.
COF 2026-21

RESULT: Placed on File VV8

ABSENT: Councillor Al-Zubi

2. Communication from Councillor Nolan transmitting a calendar update on the Health and Environment Committee
COF 2026-22

RESULT: Placed on File VV8

ABSENT: Councillor Al-Zubi

3. A communication was received from Interim City Clerk, Paula M. Crane, regarding an update regarding legislative activity.
COF 2026-23

RESULT: Placed on File VV8

ABSENT: Councillor Al-Zubi

X. APPENDED INFORMATION

1. Awaiting Report Status Update 3.9.26

AWAITING REPORT LIST

1. That the City Manager is requested to work with the School Department, the Department of Public Works, and other relevant departments to ensure that all city owned parking lots, with a focus on school complexes, including the still under construction parking at Tobin/Darby Vassal school complex, could be made available for after-hours use by residents. Original Awaiting Report Item AR-25-29
Councillor Nolan
AR 2026-02
2. The City Manager is requested to consult with the appropriate City departments, including the City Solicitor's Office, to establish a formal policy that clearly defines the City's role and financial responsibilities in supporting large-scale public events hosted by Cambridge-based non-profit and not-for-profit organizations. Original Awaiting Report Item AR-25-48
Councillor Simmons, Councillor McGovern
AR 2026-03
3. The City Manager is requested to work with all relevant departments to seek input from the community as well as direct outreach to condo owners and short-term rental operators and develop additional recommendations based on the discussion in the Ordinance Committee. Original Awaiting Report Item AR-25-51
Councillor Nolan, Councillor Sobrinho-Wheeler, Councillor McGovern, Mayor Siddiqui
AR 2026-04
4. Review the previous home rule petition and prepare a new petition that would allow Cambridge to enact a Real Estate Transfer Fee to be sent to the state legislature. Original Awaiting Report AR-25-69
Councillor Nolan, Mayor Siddiqui, Councillor Sobrinho-Wheeler, Councillor McGovern
AR 2026-06
5. Restricting Eligibility for On-Street Resident Parking Permits in New Transit-Oriented Developments. Original Awaiting Report 31839
Councillor Zusy, Vice Mayor Azeem, Councillor Nolan
AR 2026-07
6. Direct appropriate City departments, including the Department of Transportation, to evaluate and install a series of speed humps along Fayerweather Street, with particular attention to the stretch between Walnut Street and Field Street. Original Awaiting Report #31840
Councillor Simmons, Councillor Flaherty, Councillor McGovern
AR 2026-08

7. Direct the City Solicitor and the Community Development Department to review and report back to the Council on (i) legal parameters related to City funding and Tourism Destination Marketing District restrictions, and (ii) oversight and accountability related to the operation of the visitor information kiosk, and related governance expectations, including alignment with City priorities.
Original Awaiting Report ID #31841
Councillor Simmons, Councillor Flaherty
AR 2026-09
8. Work with relevant departments to prepare for a Council discussion on best future uses for City-owned properties and the processes for redevelopment. Original Awaiting Report #31842
Councillor Nolan, Mayor Siddiqui, Councillor Zusy, Councillor Al-Zubi
AR 2026-10
9. That the City Manager work with relevant departments to incorporate plant-based solutions into the Sustainable Cambridge initiative and purchasing practices in City-operated and School-related events.
Councillor Nolan, Councillor Sobrinho-Wheeler, Councillor McGovern, Mayor Siddiqui
AR 2026-11
10. That the City Manager work with relevant City departments to prioritize pilot projects in 2026 without the use of a consultant for an extensive pedestrianization study, and in the medium-term consider how additional pedestrianization of a section of Brattle Street by restoring two-way traffic to JFK Street could enhance the Square.
Councillor Nolan, Councillor Simmons, Mayor Siddiqui, Councillor Zusy
AR 2026-12
11. That the City Manager conduct a comprehensive review of existing safety and security measures at Cambridge City Hall, including an assessment of physical access controls, visitor screening practices, on-site security staffing and training, emergency response and evacuation protocols, and the use of security technologies such as surveillance systems and alarm monitoring.
Councillor Flaherty, Councillor Simmons
AR 2026-14
12. The City Manager is requested to direct the relevant City staff and departments to examine if and how the City may prevent the hiring by the Cambridge Police Department of any sworn officer who was hired by Immigration and Customs Enforcement, Homeland Security Investigations, or Customs and Border Patrol, and report back to the City Council in a timely manner.
Councillor Sobrinho-Wheeler, Councillor McGovern, Councillor Al-Zubi
AR 2026-15
13. The City Manager is requested to direct the Community Development Department (CDD) to examine the feasibility, legal considerations, and administrative requirements of permitting qualified third-party guarantors or co-signers for applicants to Inclusionary Housing units and provide recommendations as to whether such a policy could responsibly expand access to these units.
Vice Mayor Azeem, Councillor McGovern, Councillor Sobrinho-Wheeler, Councillor Simmons
AR 2026-16

14. The City Manager is requested to direct the Law Department to draft ordinance language restricting the use of City-owned or City-controlled property, facilities, resources, and personnel for the purposes of federal civil immigration enforcement, and that the Law Department evaluate whether these protections should be adopted as an amendment to the Welcoming Community Ordinance.
Mayor Siddiqui, Councillor Sobrinho-Wheeler, Councillor McGovern, Councillor Nolan, Vice Mayor Azeem, Councillor Zusy, Councillor Al-Zubi
AR 2026-17
15. The City Manager is requested to direct the appropriate departments to review the city's digital equity work to date, including the study's recommendations and all steps taken since the study conclusion in order to update the evaluation of existing internet access programs, assessing whether residents' digital needs are or could be better provided for and to propose how we can better meet their needs and to report back to the Council by June 2026 on internet access programs.
Councillor Zusy, Councillor Nolan, Councillor Sobrinho-Wheeler, Vice Mayor Azeem
AR 2026-18
16. That the City Manager is requested to assess opportunities to improve the consistency of how meeting information is posted and accessed on the City's website.
Councillor Simmons, Councillor Zusy, Councillor Sobrinho-Wheeler
AR 2026-19
17. That the City Manager be and hereby is requested to produce and deliver to the City Council, prior to the adoption of the FY27 Capital Budget, a consolidated capital lifecycle reconciliation for all major capital initiatives.
Councillor Simmons, Councillor Zusy, Councillor Flaherty
AR 2026-20
18. That the City Manager is requested to confer with relevant City staff and report back with information on the exploration of a potential Cambridge Snow Corps program.
Councillor Sobrinho-Wheeler, Councillor Nolan, Mayor Siddiqui, Councillor Al-Zubi
AR 2026-21
19. That the City Manager is requested to work with relevant City departments as well as the Election Commissioners to review guidance from the IRS and consult with other municipalities in order to simplify our processes for paying election workers.
Councillor Nolan, Councillor Sobrinho-Wheeler, Councillor McGovern, Councillor Zusy
AR 2026-22
20. That the City Manager is requested to work with the City Council and relevant City departments on the process by which Cambridge can expand free early child care offerings, including models for means-tested programming, and exploration of non-City funding sources, from the state or foundations.
Councillor Nolan, Councillor McGovern, Mayor Siddiqui
AR 2026-23

XII. ADJOURNMENT
